AI career system: role preparation, portfolio evidence and a realistic job search

One career system: preparation, applications and feedback

Combine a 60-day AI-role preparation sprint with a 90-day job-search routine. Neither guarantees an offer or sets an employer deadline. The gated packs were not obtained; this is Kiln's independent synthesis, updated November 2, 2026. Both reel links remain attached.

Choose a role and evidence target

Choose one track using responsibilities in real employer postings.

Track	Bounded portfolio task	Evidence to present
AI product manager	Specify and evaluate one AI feature for a clear user task	Product brief, quality rubric, cost and failure decisions
Forward-deployed engineer	Integrate a realistic customer workflow	Working API/data integration, deployment notes and a clear explanation
AI engineer	Build and evaluate an inference or retrieval application	Reproducible code, test set, latency/cost report and failure analysis

Map requirements to real work; keep gaps visible.

Preparation inside the search routine

Period	Preparation deliverable	Application and feedback work
Days 1-7	Role matrix and scoped project with acceptance criteria	Honest resume/profile, original posting URLs and tracker
Days 8-21	Learn needed foundations and reproduce a small example	Apply to suitable roles; request specific feedback
Days 22-42	Complete a vertical workflow and evaluation	Continue applications, practice interviews and review funnel stages
Days 43-60	Improve the weakest result and write a case study	Explain tradeoffs clearly; revise evidence-based resume bullets
Days 61-90	Deepen the most relevant skill gap	Diagnose channel and interview results; choose the next cohort

Apply before preparation finishes when suitable roles are available. Follow posting deadlines; January 1 in the reel is a self-imposed target. Divide available time among screening, tailoring, practice and follow-up.

Public resources

- Hugging Face's LLM course (https://huggingface.co/learn/llm-course/chapter1/1) supplies model-tooling lessons.
- Microsoft's Generative AI for Beginners (https://github.com/microsoft/generative-ai-for-beginners) offers examples; inspect lesson prerequisites and service charges.
- Full Stack Deep Learning's LLM Bootcamp (https://fullstackdeeplearning.com/llm-bootcamp/) provides useful systems framing from 2023. Check current SDK documentation before using old examples.
- MIT's resume guidance (https://capd.mit.edu/resources/resumes/), Simplify's new-grad discovery list (https://github.com/SimplifyJobs/New-Grad-Positions) and Handshake (https://joinhandshake.com/students/) are independent starting points retained from the earlier guide. Confirm any discovered role on the employer's own page.

These are independent resources. No automation was installed, application submitted or outreach sent.

Referrals and useful metrics

Ashby's referral study (https://www.ashbyhq.com/talent-trends-report/reports/referrals) examines historical 2021-2024 application data and reports stronger interview progression for referred applicants. Selection effects mean it is not an individual success multiplier or proof of a 24-hour application rule. Do not wait indefinitely for a referral and miss a deadline; check the employer's process to avoid duplicate submissions.

Track applications, screens, interviews and offers by channel and cohort, with equal follow-up windows. Small samples are unstable. Diagnose the weakest stage: targeting, evidence, communication or interviews.

Reusable prompt

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Using these employer postings and only my real experience, choose one AI
role track and create a 60-day preparation sprint inside a 90-day search
routine. Connect every portfolio task to a requirement and an evaluation.
Plan applications, role-specific practice and weekly funnel reviews.
Preserve missing evidence and unknown restrictions. Suggest public
resources, state costs, and draft outreach for me to edit. Do not send,
apply, invent achievements or promise an offer on a fixed schedule.
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Project idea and next action

Build a private tracker joining role URLs, stages, follow-ups, requirement evidence and learning outcomes. Use fictional public fixtures. The application tracker and requirements matrix start empty. Begin with one track, a few postings and a small project you can finish and explain.

Original sources

- https://www.instagram.com/reel/DeaHhcTKVkS/
- https://www.instagram.com/reel/DfN8T42qZBa/